Singapore Company Update

UOB

Bloomberg: UOB SP | Reuters: UOBH.SI

Refer to important disclosures at the end of this report

DBS Group Research . Equity

8 Aug 2025

HOLD

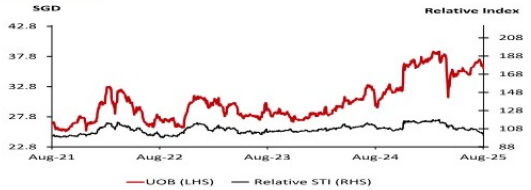
Last Traded Price (7 Aug 2025): SGD35.81 (STI : 4,258.15)
Price Target 12-mth: SGD33.90 (5% downside) (Prev SGD32.70)

Analysts
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What's New

- 2Q25 revenue and net profit missed consensus by 3% and 9%, respectively
- Net interest margin narrowed by 9bps q/q due to lower asset yields amid declining benchmark rates
- Higher new NPA formation driven by a single US commercial real estate exposure; SPs still elevated at 32bps (1Q25: 19bps)
- Maintain HOLD, TP SGD33.90

Price Relative



Forecasts and Valuation

FY Dec (SGDmn)	2024A	2025F	2026F	2027F
Pre-prov. Profit	7,956	7,924	8,297	8,632
Net Profit	6,045	5,694	6,041	6,259
Net Pft (Pre Ex.)	6,233	5,694	6,041	6,259
Net Pft Gth (Pre-ex) (%)	2.8	(8.6)	6.1	3.6
EPS (S cts)	359	338	358	371
EPS Pre Ex. (S cts)	370	338	358	371
EPS Gth Pre Ex (%)	3	(9)	6	4
Diluted EPS (S cts)	359	338	358	371
PE Pre Ex. (X)	9.7	10.6	10.0	9.6
Net DPS (S cts)	179	172	183	561
Div Yield (%)	5.0	4.8	5.1	15.7
ROAE Pre Ex. (%)	13.0	11.1	11.2	11.3
ROAE (%)	12.6	11.1	11.2	11.3
ROA (%)	1.1	1.0	1.0	1.0
BV Per Share (S cts)	2,950	3,115	3,291	3,291
P/Book Value (x)	1.2	1.1	1.1	1.1
Earnings Rev (%):		(7)	(3)	(6)
Consensus EPS (S cts):		351	369	397
Other Broker Recs:		B: 9	S: 1	H: 8

Source of all data on this page: Company, DBS, Bloomberg

Keeping watch on asset quality

Investment Thesis:

Growing an enlarged franchise. UOB's acquisition of Citigroup's consumer businesses in Indonesia, Malaysia, Thailand, and Vietnam allows it to accelerate, scale up, and deepen its ASEAN franchise; the effective execution of this remains key to long-term synergies. Integration is on track, as UOB continues to leverage an enlarged base of ~8.4mn customers. Amid macroeconomic uncertainty, management revised down its return on equity (ROE) from 14% to 12%-13%.

Sequential impact from an escalating trade war environment. We believe there are downside risks to earnings in an escalating trade war environment given the extensive and broad US tariffs. Furthermore, UOB posseses the largest ASEAN exposure amongst Singapore banks, with 82% of its group profit before tax derived from the region. Following a pause in guidance in 1Q25, management has reinstated its outlook, revising all guidance downward except for credit costs. Around 10% of its loans relate to trade financing.

Keeping watch on asset quality. We remain watchful of asset quality risks in an environment of slower global growth amidst concerns of accelerating Fed cuts, on top of UOB's commercial real estate (CRE) exposures. UOB's average loan-to-value (LTV) for office CRE continues to be ~50%, providing a buffer in the event underlying collateral valuations collapse. In 2Q25, new NPA formation was higher q/q, at SGD472mn, driven by a specific US CRE exposure, where pre-emptive general provisions (GPs) have been set aside.

Maintain HOLD, TP SGD33.90. We maintain HOLD with revised TP of SGD33.90, based on the Gordon Growth Model (12% ROE, 3% growth, and 11% cost of equity [previous: 11.5%]), representing ~1.0x FY26F, slightly below the average of UOB's 15-year historical forward P/BV multiple. We believe valuations will reflect an environment of slower growth and accelerating rate cuts going forward.

Key Risks

Deteriorating asset quality. Higher-than-expected non-performing loans (NPLs), high inflationary pressure, and recessionary risks could unwind expectations of credit cost and NPL declines, thus posing risks to earnings. A credit cycle will typically cause banks' share prices to derate.

Fed cuts. Faster-than-expected Fed cuts also pose downside risks to our earnings estimates.

At A Glance

Issued Capital (mn shrs)	1,672
Mkt. Cap (SGDmn/USDmn)	59,862 / 46,567
Major Shareholders (%)	
Wee Investments Pte	8.0
Wah Hin & Co Pte Ltd	5.2
Free Float (%)	86.9
3m Avg. Daily Val (USDmn)	77.1
GIC Industry : Financial / Banks	

DBS Insights Direct

Watchlist the stock on Insights Direct to receive prompt updates

ed: BM/ sa: DT, PY, CS

WHAT'S NEW

Management reinstated FY25F guidance, revising all guidance downwards except for credit costs

2Q25 revenue and net profit missed consensus. Revenue came in at SGD3,465mn (flat y/y, -5% q/q), while net profit was SGD1,338mn (-6% y/y, -10% q/q). Net interest income (NII) moderated to SGD2,336mn (-3% y/y, -3% q/q) as asset growth cushioned effects of sharp decline in benchmark rate. Net interest margin (NIM) declined 9bps q/q to 1.91% (1Q25: Stable q/q at 2.00%) on lower asset yields amid declining benchmark rates. Operating costs improved modestly to SGD1,535mn (flat y/y, -2% q/q), resulting in a cost-to-income (C/I) ratio of 44.3% (1Q25: 42.6%).

Non-interest income rose 5% y/y but declined 10% q/q. Net fee income stood at SGD636mn (+3% y/y, -8% q/q), normalising from last quarter's record high, as wealth fees was affected by investors' cautious approach amid macroeconomic uncertainties. Other non-interest income of SGD493mn (+8% y/y, -11% q/q) was driven by lower trading and liquidity management activities.

Lower credit cost of 32bps; NPL stable at 1.6%. 1Q25 credit cost was 32bps, inclusive of a higher specific allowance q/q pertaining to the marking down of collateral valuations. Total loan provisions amounted to SGD274mn, 32bps (4Q25: SGD289mn, 35bps), including general provisions (stage 1+2): SGD1mn, 0bps (1Q25: SGD133mn, 16bps) and specific provisions (stage 3): SGD273mn, 32bps (1Q25: SGD156mn, 19bps). New NPA formation was higher q/q at SGD472mn due to a single US CRE exposure, where pre-emptive GPs have been set aside (1Q25: SGD400mn, average of SGD391mn for last four quarters). NPL ratio remained stable at 1.6%.

Management has reinstated FY25F guidance, revising all guidance downward except for credit costs. Management has guided for FY25F NIM in the range of 1.85%–1.90% (previous: Maintain NIM at ~2%), low single-digit loan growth (previous: high single-digit loan growth), and high single-digit fee income growth (previous: double-digit fee income growth). Management projects flat operating expenses for FY25F (no prior guidance), reduced its prior guidance for total income, and maintains credit cost guidance at 25-30bps, while adding that it expects to top up the general provision buffer.

Takeaways from management briefings

NIM: Exit NIM was 1.84%. Management assumes three Fed rate cuts totalling 75bps and expects the 3M SORA to land at 1.7% by year-end, deriving its full-year NIM guidance of 1.85%-1.90%. The NIM decline has been mitigated by ongoing proactive management, including repricing fixed deposits and saving account rates and a change in the asset-liability mix. Management anticipates less severe movement in SORA during 2H compared to 1H. It remains hopeful of maintaining asset yields in 2H, particularly due to intense competition in 1H, where everyone pursued higher quality loan assets. In Hong Kong, funding is primarily conducted via swaps rather than deposits, which will be reflected in markets revenue rather than NIM. While management has levers at its disposal to manage NIM, it acknowledges the need to balance this with the impact on customer relationships and franchise value. The focus remains on maximising both NII and NIM.

Loans: 1.3% of loans are related to major exporters to the US (>25% of exports to US), although the second-order impact, particularly from tariffs on growth and consumer sentiment, remains difficult to guage. Loan momentum in 2H is expected to continue, specifically in mortgages, trade loans, and large corporates. The overall loan book comprises 80% floating-rate loans. US CRE loans make up 0.8% of the total loan book, with most exposures pertaining to network customers investing in gateway cities.

Asset quality: New NPA formation was higher due to single US CRE exposure, where pre-emptive GPs have been set aside. Special provisions (SPs) were primarily related to markdowns of collateral valuations, with some valuations having crashed by as much as 80% from their peak. Credit costs at Citi have normalised. In Thailand, SPs remained elevated in 1H, partly due to a fraud case. Additionally, there was a slight uptick in mortgage NPLs from 1.1% to 1.2%, driven by Thai mortgages. Regarding the GP buffer, management is gradually building it towards 0.9% over the medium term, with an expectation to reach slightly higher than 0.8% by the end of this year.

Non-interest income: Net new money in 2Q25 stood at SGD3bn (1Q25: ~SGD1.5-2bn). Approximately 60% of overall wealth management funds are in fixed deposits, with much of the past year's growth in assets under management (AUM) originating from deposits; the deposits-to-investment ratio has remained largely constant. Post 1H, customer risk appetite has returned, leading to them making switches from deposits into investments.

Dividends, capital, ROE: Management revised down its medium-term ROE target from 14% to 12%-13%. It guided for an optimal liquidity coverage ratio (LCR) of 120%, and UOB is increasing its high-quality liquid assets (HQLA) to increase its LCR. Regarding dividends, the quantum of dividends is reviewed consistently and regularly. For now, management will stick to its 50% dividend payout ratio and commitment to returning capital. As the current share buyback programme concludes, management will assess the suitability of initiating another tranche.

Company Background

UOB provides a wide range of financial services through its global network of branches, offices, subsidiaries, and associates: Personal financial services, private banking, commercial and corporate banking, investment banking, corporate finance, capital market activities, treasury services, futures broking, asset management, venture capital management, insurance, and stockbroking services.

Quarterly / Interim Income Statement (SGDmn)

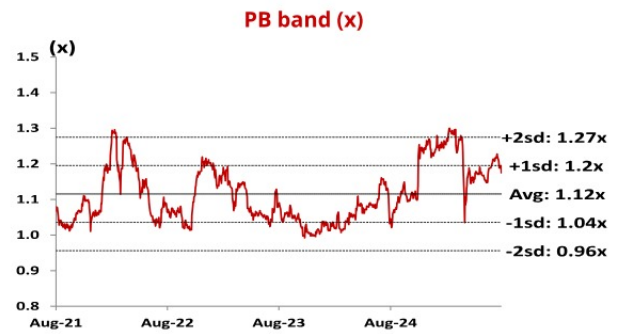
FY Dec	2Q2024	1Q2025	2Q2025	% chg y/y	% chg q/q
Net Interest Income	2,401	2,409	2,336	(2.7)	(3.0)
Non-Interest Income	1,075	1,248	1,129	5.0	(9.5)
Operating Income	**3,476**	**3,657**	**3,465**	**(0.3)**	**(5.3)**
Operating Expenses	(1,459)	(1,566)	(1,544)	5.8	(1.4)
Pre-Provision Profit	**2,017**	**2,091**	**1,921**	**(4.8)**	**(8.1)**
Provisions	(232)	(290)	(279)	20.3	(3.8)
Associates	31.0	22.0	(3.0)	nm	(113.6)
Exceptionals	(64.0)	0.0	0.0	nm	-
Pretax Profit	**1,752**	**1,823**	**1,639**	**(6.4)**	**(10.1)**
Taxation	(327)	(333)	(301)	(8.0)	(9.6)
Minority Interests	0.0	0.0	0.0	-	-
Net Profit	**1,425**	**1,490**	**1,338**	**(6.1)**	**(10.2)**
Growth (%)					
Net Interest Income Gth	1.7	(1.7)	(3.0)		
Net Profit Gth	(4.2)	(2.2)	(10.2)		
Key ratio (%)					
NIM	2.1	2.1	2.0		
NPL ratio	1.5	1.6	1.6		
Loan-to deposit	83.4	84.0	83.7		
Cost-to-income	42.0	42.8	44.6		
Total CAR	15.9	18.2	17.9		

Source of all data: Company, DBS

Historical PE and PB band



Source: Bloomberg, DBS estimates



Source: Bloomberg, DBS estimates

Key Assumptions

FY Dec	2023A	2024A	2025F	2026F	2027F
Gross Loans Growth	0.5	5.2	6.5	6.0	6.0
Customer Deposits Growth	4.6	4.8	5.0	5.0	5.0
Yld. On Earnings Assets	4.8	4.9	4.2	4.1	4.0
Avg Cost Of Funds	2.9	3.0	2.5	2.4	2.4

Income Statement (SGDmn)

FY Dec	2023A	2024A	2025F	2026F	2027F
Net Interest Income	9,679	9,674	9,370	9,531	9,843
Non-Interest Income	4,253	4,620	4,770	5,107	5,257
Operating Income	13,932	14,294	14,140	14,637	15,100
Operating Expenses	(6,241)	(6,338)	(6,216)	(6,341)	(6,468)
Pre-provision Profit	7,691	7,956	7,924	8,297	8,632
Provisions	(921)	(926)	(1,035)	(1,023)	(1,092)
Associates	93.0	121	81.0	121	121
Exceptionals	(350)	(188)	0.0	0.0	0.0
Pre-tax Profit	6,863	7,151	6,970	7,394	7,661
Taxation	(1,138)	(1,092)	(1,255)	(1,331)	(1,379)
Minority Interests	(14.0)	(14.0)	(20.9)	(22.2)	(23.0)
Preference Dividend	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Net Profit	5,711	6,045	5,694	6,041	6,259
Net Profit bef Except	6,061	6,233	5,694	6,041	6,259
Growth (%)					
Net Interest Income Gth	16.0	(0.1)	(3.1)	1.7	3.3
Net Profit Gth	24.9	5.8	(5.8)	6.1	3.6
Margins, Costs & Efficiency (%)					
Spread	1.9	1.8	1.7	1.7	1.6
Net Interest Margin	2.1	2.0	1.9	1.8	1.8
Cost-to-Income Ratio	44.8	44.3	44.0	43.3	42.8
Business Mix (%)					
Net Int. Inc / Opg Inc.	69.5	67.7	66.3	65.1	65.2
Non-Int. Inc / Opg inc.	30.5	32.3	33.7	34.9	34.8
Fee Inc / Opg Income	16.0	16.8	19.2	20.9	20.2
Oth Non-Int Inc/Opg Inc	14.5	15.6	14.5	14.0	14.6
Profitability (%)					
ROAE Pre Ex.	13.5	13.0	11.1	11.2	11.3
ROAE	12.7	12.6	11.1	11.2	11.3
ROA Pre Ex.	1.2	1.2	1.0	1.0	1.0
ROA	1.1	1.1	1.0	1.0	1.0

Source: Company, DBS

Quarterly / Interim Income Statement (SGDmn)

FY Dec	2Q2024	3Q2024	4Q2024	1Q2025	2Q2025
Net Interest Income	2,401	2,460	2,451	2,409	2,336
Non-Interest Income	1,075	1,374	1,010	1,248	1,129
Operating Income	**3,476**	**3,834**	**3,461**	**3,657**	**3,465**
Operating Expenses	(1,459)	(1,597)	(1,587)	(1,566)	(1,544)
Pre-Provision Profit	**2,017**	**2,237**	**1,874**	**2,091**	**1,921**
Provisions	(232)	(304)	(227)	(290)	(279)
Associates	31.0	25.0	40.0	22.0	(3.0)
Exceptionals	(64.0)	(28.0)	(17.0)	0.0	0.0
Pretax Profit	**1,752**	**1,930**	**1,670**	**1,823**	**1,639**
Taxation	(327)	(320)	(147)	(333)	(301)
Minority Interests	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Net Profit	**1,425**	**1,610**	**1,523**	**1,490**	**1,338**
Growth (%)					
Net Interest Income Gth	1.7	2.5	(0.4)	(1.7)	(3.0)
Net Profit Gth	(4.2)	13.0	(5.4)	(2.2)	(10.2)

Balance Sheet (SGDmn)

FY Dec	2023A	2024A	2025F	2026F	2027F
Cash/Bank Balance	52,350	38,577	40,506	42,531	44,658
Government Securities	38,280	46,851	47,556	48,272	48,998
Inter Bank Assets	35,093	37,432	39,779	42,085	44,529
Total Net Loans & Advs.	317,005	333,930	354,865	375,440	397,241
Investment	50,793	48,472	52,688	57,384	62,970
Associates	1,266	1,302	1,383	1,504	1,625
Fixed Assets	3,782	4,169	1,667	1,667	1,667
Goodwill	4,984	4,979	4,142	4,142	4,142
Other Assets	19,967	21,952	23,328	24,681	26,114
Total Assets	**523,520**	**537,664**	**565,914**	**597,707**	**631,945**
Customer Deposits	385,469	403,978	424,177	445,386	467,655
Inter Bank Deposits	32,371	19,735	23,598	27,390	37,759
Debts/Borrowings	36,280	41,367	41,367	41,367	41,367
Others	22,932	22,627	24,004	27,814	29,390
Minorities	242	224	245	267	290
Shareholders' Funds	46,226	49,733	52,523	55,483	55,483
Total Liab& S/H's Funds	**523,520**	**537,664**	**565,914**	**597,707**	**631,945**

Source: Company, DBS

Financial Stability Measures (%)

FY Dec	2023A	2024A	2025F	2026F	2027F
Balance Sheet Structure					
Loan-to-Deposit Ratio	82.2	82.7	83.7	84.3	84.9
Net Loans / Total Assets	60.6	62.1	62.7	62.8	62.9
Investment / Total Assets	9.7	9.0	9.3	9.6	10.0
Cust . Dep./Int. Bear. Liab.	84.9	86.9	86.7	86.6	85.5
Interbank Dep / Int. Bear.	7.1	4.2	4.8	5.3	6.9
Asset Quality					
NPL / Total Gross Loans	1.5	1.5	1.5	1.5	1.5
NPL / Total Assets	0.9	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0
Loan Loss Reserve Coverage	85.1	75.5	90.3	102.7	114.5
Provision Charge-Off Rate	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.3
Capital Strength					
Total CAR	16.6	18.7	16.4	16.4	15.5
Tier-1 CAR	13.4	15.5	13.7	13.8	13.1

Source: Company, DBS

Target Price & Ratings 12-mth History



S.No.	Date of Report	Closing Price	12-mth Target Price	Rating
1:	08 Nov 24	35.69	37.90	BUY
2:	20 Feb 25	38.43	38.50	BUY
3:	08 Apr 25	32.13	32.70	HOLD
4:	07 May 25	34.49	32.70	HOLD

***Note** : Share price and Target price are adjusted for corporate actions.*

Source: DBS

Analysts: Rui Wen LIM

Singapore Research Team

DBS Group Research recommendations are based on an Absolute Total Return* Rating system, defined as follows:
STRONG BUY (>20% total return over the next 3 months, with identifiable share price catalysts within this time frame)
BUY (>15% total return over the next 12 months for small caps, >10% for large caps)
HOLD (-10% to +15% total return over the next 12 months for small caps, -10% to +10% for large caps)
FULLY VALUED (negative total return, i.e., > -10% over the next 12 months)
SELL (negative total return of > -20% over the next 3 months, with identifiable share price catalysts within this time frame)

**Share price appreciation + dividends*

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Sources for all charts and tables are DBS unless otherwise specified.

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